CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which phrase suggests a gap between claim and reality? 1

(a) a little white house **(b)** a little black kitten
(c) brave as a barrel full of bears **(d)** a pet dragon

2. The ending's repetition of the opening comparisons creates: 1

(a) circular closure **(b)** confusion **(c)** tension **(d)** a new plot

3. The poem subverts the stereotype of: 1

(a) the fierce dragon **(b)** the loyal dog
(c) the brave pirate **(d)** the clever mouse

4. In 'Custard cried for a nice safe cage', 'nice safe' conveys: 1

(a) disdain
(b) anger
(c) childlike simplicity and comic understatement
(d) bravery

5. The poem's moral is conveyed best by: 1

(a) a list of rules **(b)** showing Custard's deed
(c) a sermon **(d)** a speech

6. The effect of the double use of 'little' is to: 1

(a) show dislike **(b)** add rhyme only
(c) show size **(d)** emphasise cosiness and smallness

7. Choose the sentence with inversion for emphasis. 1

(a) Never had the pets been so scared. **(b)** Scared the pets never had been.
(c) The pets scared never. **(d)** The pets had never been so scared.

8. The poem appeals across ages because: 1

(a) it is political **(b)** humour and a simple moral are universal
(c) it is long **(d)** it is difficult

9. The treatment of the pirate as a stock villain is for: 1

(a) comic simplicity **(b)** realism **(c)** tragic effect **(d)** moral complexity

10. Choose the correct conditional: 'If Custard ___ the pirate, the family would have been in danger.' 1

(a) did not fight **(b)** has not fought **(c)** had not fought **(d)** would not fight

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How does the poem balance silliness and seriousness? 2

12. Discuss the contrast between scale and character in the poem. 2

13. Comment on the effect of stock characters. 2

14. What might the dragon symbolise? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. How does the poem comment on social labelling? 3

16. Write a four-line stanza in the poem's style about a timid tiger. 3

17. What makes the poem a good choice for a class recitation? 3

OR

Compare Custard with Valli ('Madam Rides the Bus') as characters who surprise us. 3

18. Convert into the passive: 'Custard gobbled up the pirate.' 3

OR

Why might a reader see the poem as more than a children's rhyme? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Prepare a performance plan for a class recitation of the poem. 5

OR

Write a debate speech: 'Boasting is a sign of weakness'. 5

20. Write a new ballad (10 lines) about a gentle giant who surprises everyone. 5

OR

Discuss the contribution of rhyme and rhythm to the poem's meaning. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND